Emerging AI Roles → IK India Curriculum Gap Analysis

India market · last 2 months · Naukri + LinkedIn

Window: 2026-04-16 → 2026-06-17 · **Generated:** 2026-06-18 **Evidence base:** 658 AI/ML job rows (637 = 97% date-confirmed in-window) · LinkedIn 471 + Naukri 187 · **Spend $2.23 / $5 cap (no overshoot)** **Method:** deterministic title extraction + skills mining, mapped against IK's 19-course / 67-tag curriculum (`curriculum_coverage.json`); narrative synthesis by Claude with every claim tied to scraped counts.

TL;DR for managers

1. **IK's core bet is correct and market-validated.** The two largest emerging role-clusters in India right now are **GenAI/LLM Engineer (124)** and **AI Agent / Agentic AI Engineer (66)**, and the #1–2 most-demanded skills are **Agents (41% of postings)** and **RAG (31%)** — exactly IK's deepest coverage. No pivot needed; lean in.
2. **The market is mostly *renaming*, not inventing.** Of 75 "novel/unmapped" titles, the top ones — *AI Developer, AIML Engineer, AI/ML Developer* — are India naming variants of roles IK already covers. **Few genuinely net-new role *categories* exist beyond IK's catalog.** The real gaps are **depth & positioning**, not missing role types.
3. **Three concrete gaps worth acting on:** (a) **cloud diversity** — market wants Azure (23%) ≥ AWS (20%) + GCP (14%), IK is **AWS-only**; (b) **production LLMOps/MLOps** — 46 in-market roles, thin in IK outside Flagship ML; (c) **AI Evaluation** as a *named* outcome — strong skill demand (20%) + emerging "Eval Engineer" titles, currently taught but not positioned as a role.

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1. Emerging roles in the market vs IK coverage (Gap Matrix)

Emerging role (market)	Openings	In-window	IK coverage (corrected)	Verdict
GenAI / LLM Engineer	**124**	118	Deep (all EdgeUp + PwC + ML)	✅ Covered — core strength
AI Agent / Agentic AI Engineer	**66**	64	Deep (multi-agent, MCP/A2A across 13 tracks)	✅ Covered — core strength
AI / ML Architect *(seniority)*	**50**	—	Covered (AI/ML Architect outcome)	✅ Covered — well-aligned
MLOps / LLMOps Engineer	**46**	46	Partial — concentrated in Flagship ML only	🔴 **Strengthen**
Prompt Engineer	19	19	Covered as skill (not named role)	✅ Covered
AI Platform / Infra / Inference	4	4	Thin — no serving/inference track	🔴 Emerging gap (small)

Emerging role (market)	Openings	In-window	IK coverage (corrected)	Verdict
RAG / Retrieval Engineer	4*	4	Deep (Agentic RAG, GraphRAG, hybrid)	✅ Covered
AI Safety / Governance	4	4	Partial (guardrails, RBAC, PII)	🟣 Low India demand — watch
Applied AI / Research Scientist	3	3	Gap (IK is applied, not research)	🟣 Low demand — likely intentional
Forward-Deployed AI Engineer	1	1	Not positioned	🟣 Negligible India signal

*RAG/LLM-Engineer/Prompt counts understate true demand — those skills appear *inside* GenAI roles (RAG skill = 31% of all postings), not as standalone titles.

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2. Skills/tools demand vs curriculum (the sharper signal)

Skill / Tool	% of postings	In IK curriculum?	Note
Agents / tool use	**41%**	✅ Yes (deep)	IK's #1 strength = market's #1 skill
RAG	**31%**	✅ Yes (deep)	Agentic RAG, GraphRAG, hybrid
Azure	**23%**	❌ **No (AWS-only)**	🔴 **Top gap**
AWS	20%	✅ Yes	—
Fine-tuning (LoRA/PEFT)	20%	✅ Yes	—
Prompt Engineering	20%	✅ Yes	—
LLM Eval (LangSmith/RAGAS/DeepEval)	**20%**	✅ Yes (taught, not branded a role)	Elevate to named outcome
LangChain	20%	✅ Yes	—
Vector DB (FAISS/Chroma/Qdrant)	16%	✅ Yes	(auto-tool flagged this wrong; IK *does* teach it)
TensorFlow / PyTorch	15% / 15%	✅ Yes (Flagship ML / DS)	—
GCP / Vertex AI	**14%**	❌ **No**	🔴 Cloud gap
LangGraph	10%	✅ Yes	—

Read: IK matches the market on the *AI substance* (agents, RAG, fine-tuning, eval, vector DBs, LangChain/LangGraph). The clearest, highest-ROI miss is **cloud breadth** — the market increasingly asks for

Azure (23%) and GCP (14%), and IK teaches **AWS only**.

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3. What the "novelty net" caught (light lens-2)

75 rows (40 distinct titles) mapped to *no* known role bucket. The point of this net was to catch genuinely new naming. Finding:

- **Mostly nomenclature, not new capability:** `AI Developer` (10), `AIML Engineer` (10), `AI/ML Developer` (3), `AI Specialist`, `AI Consultant` — India-market synonyms for roles IK already trains.
- **A few worth noting:** `Applied Research Scientist – AI Models & Agents` (research-leaning, not IK's applied audience); `Software Engineer, ML Systems` (ML-infra leaning); `AI Developer – Agent Specialist` (agentic, covered).
- **Takeaway:** the absence of a long tail of net-new *role types* is itself the finding — **IK's catalog spans the role space; the market is iterating on titles, not inventing categories.**

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4. Prioritized recommendations (to update the Program Master Index)

#	Action	Why (evidence)	Effort
1	**Stay the course on Agentic + GenAI + RAG**	#1–2 role clusters (124, 66) and #1–2 skills (Agents 41%, RAG 31%)	None — validation
2	**Add Azure AI + GCP Vertex modules** (cross-track)	Azure 23% (≥ AWS), GCP 14%; IK is AWS-only	Medium — highest ROI
3	**Stand up a dedicated LLMOps / AI-Platform module**	46 MLOps roles in-window; thin outside Flagship ML; AI-Platform/Inference emerging	Medium
4	**Brand "AI Evaluation Engineer" as a named outcome/badge**	Eval skills 20% + emerging "Eval Engineer" titles; already taught	Low — repackage
5	**Marketing/SEO: align titles to India search terms**	"AI/ML Developer", "AIML Engineer", "AI Developer" dominate India naming	Low
6	**Watch, don't build yet:** AI Safety/Governance, Forward-Deployed, AI Research	Low India demand now (4/1/3) — revisit next quarter	Monitor

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5. Honest caveats (read before presenting)

- **2-month point-in-time sample, not a time-trend** — "emerging" = present-and-novel relative to IK's curriculum and canonical roles, not a measured rise over time (no historical baseline exists).
- **Sample, not census** — 658 rows from 2 sources under a $2.23 budget; counts show *relative* demand reliably, not absolute market size. Naukri stopped at 4/8 queries (budget ceiling), so Naukri is under-weighted vs LinkedIn.
- **Skills mined from job descriptions** by keyword match — directional, not exhaustive.

- **Coverage judgments** corrected manually against `curriculum_coverage.json` (auto-flags had false negatives, e.g. Vector DB, LLM-Eval).
- Everything is reproducible from `emerging_rows.json` + `emerging_aggregates.json` + the raw per-query JSON.